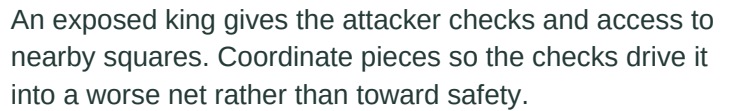


Exposed-king tactics

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on e8. Absolute pin: knight on c6.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

12.Bxc6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the knight on c6. Recorded reply: **12...bxc6**.

14.Qe5+ Check restricts Black to 6 legal replies here. From e5 it attacks king on e8 and rook on h8.

At the end, nominal material is White 31 / Black 32 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.